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**Framing Trump's 2024 Election Victory**  
**A Critical Discourse Analysis of Flemish Media**  
**Narratives in *De Morgen*, *Doorbraak* and**  
***Apache***

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## Abstract

This study applies a Critical Discourse Analysis (CDA) to examine how three Flemish media outlets – *Doorbraak*, *Apache* and *De Morgen* – discursively construct Donald Trump's 2024 re-election and its broader impact on the democratic debate within the Flemish media landscape. By exploring existing fault lines, this paper examines media pluralism and specific mechanisms of (de)politicizing the debate while using theoretical foundations from Mouffe and Carvalho. The paper analyses 26 published articles between the November 4th and the December 4<sup>th</sup>, 2024. The findings of this paper reveal differences in the discursive construction and ideological cultures of the Flemish media outlets. *Doorbraak* generally frames Trump as a populist victor, standing up against progressive elites. *Apache* critiques systemic failures *across* the political spectrum, while *De Morgen* emphasized global risk and institutional stability. In the conclusion, the paper delves deeper into what opening and closing the debate surrounding this topic looks like. These narratives reflect different contributions to agonistic pluralism and the larger debate surrounding this topic. The study highlights our media's role in either fostering or impeding on democratic debate in a Flemish context.

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## Introduction

The 2024 U.S. presidential elections have been a central focal point in political discourse. With not only local, but equal amounts of international attention, the world has been anticipating this election which has been called '*pivotal for global health policy*', affecting both global governance as well as health funding and international relations (Meier et al., 2024). Uncovering how this discourse is represented in Flemish media can teach the public about the strategies used, frames applied and contributions added to the pluralistic debate surrounding this topic, offering a background for the reader to situate the topic and its framing within a larger media landscape.

### *Donald Trump: A Polarizing Figure in Modern Politics*

With the U.S.' economy being the largest in the world (World Bank Group, 2024), the effect of its policies can extend way beyond the borders of America, affecting the economic and political reactions of other countries around the world (Carlin & Hellwig, 2020). Within that sphere, president-elect Donald Trump can be seen as one of the most polarizing figures in modern history (Rottinghaus et al., 2018). Whether you agree with his policies or not, the fact that his previous term, as well as the race to his re-election, have been discussed in nearly every corner of the world speaks of a relevant moment worth shining a brighter light on. With recent examples of his assassination attempt, outspoken remarks in his debate with presidential candidate Harris, a general focus on heavy, divisive language (Saramo, 2017) and ongoing lawsuits investigating alleged sexual assault and fraud, it is at least valid to state that his tactics are uncommon for a political leader of his stature.

### *Fault Lines in Democratic Debate*

Trump's victory and its surrounding debate can be further situated within broader existing societal fault lines. Trump's immigration policies, scepticism towards international organizations (*e.g. WHO, NATO, Paris Climate Agreement*) and other so-called 'America First'-ideas all point to his nationalist rhetoric, often clashing with other nation's more liberal, globalist ideas. This illustrates a first fault line that's omnipresent in the democratic debate regarding Trump. Besides that, his rejection of the 2020 election results had many Americans fearing a similar outcome if he weren't to win in this year's elections (Itkowitz et al., 2024), pointing to Trump's hesitancy in trusting the democratic process and electoral legitimacy of his nation. This mistrust can be recognised in other areas as well, like his distrust in mainstream media and his '*fake news*'-rhetoric all evidential of a form of *post-truth politics*: a reality in which one's personal politics, emotions and beliefs are more important than objective facts or evidence. In this post-truth landscape, leaders appeal more to the people's fears and desires rather than general truths (Hannon, 2023), something Trump isn't afraid of doing himself. Other noteworthy fault lines relate to economic prosperity vs. environmentalism, with examples like Trump stepping out of the Paris Climate Agreement and calling climate change 'fake news' (Allen & McAleer, 2018). Individualism vs. collective collaboration can also often be extracted from the wider debate surrounding this topic, as will be further discussed in the analysis of this paper.

Together with these fault lines, Trump's re-election sparked international media discourse, reflecting on broader societal fault lines and reaching further than just the U.S. These dynamics fuel political division and shape global perceptions, all influenced by how media gets these ideas in our papers and on our screens. By uncovering these narratives, this research highlights the role of media in shaping the democratic debate and situating global political events within. Questioning this is necessary to gain a deeper understanding of the course of the debate and thus empowering media users to be wary and critically engage with the information they consume.

### *Research Context and Objectives*

Examining how this discourse is being framed in a *local* context can teach us how our media contributes to shaping the discourse around a certain topic. This study will examine Trump's victory as reported by three Flemish media outlets: *De Morgen*, *Doorbraak* and *Apache*. Their known ideological positioning will be further discussed in the methodology section, without letting it influence the analysis of their articles. Using a Critical Discourse Analysis, this paper hopes to unveil parts of which ideological frameworks are being used and set up by these three distinct different media outlets. It teaches us how a foreign media event, like Trump's victory, is constructed in a Flemish (political) media context of a world leader's victory.

The aim of this study is to analyse how the selected outlets, both alternative and legacy media, discursively (re)construct the reality of Trump's victory. Only later, after a full and independent article analysis, will these findings be discussed in relation to the existing and presumed ideological stance of each outlet. The general research question can be constructed as follows: *How do De Morgen, Doorbraak, and Apache discursively construct Donald Trump's 2024 re-election, and to what extent do their constructions open or close the space for democratic debate?* The aim of this critical discourse analysis is to assess the discursive roles of alternative and legacy media in the context of the populist moment. A potential hypothesis is that the different media's coverage of Trump's victory likely reveals varying discursive constructions, emphasizing different themes, actors, and strategies while employing distinct forms of (de)legitimization and different forms of inclusion and omission.

In an ideal, democratic world, a healthy debate surrounding this topic should centre its conversation around a core ideological struggle, like populism vs. liberal democracy. This would mean rising above moralizing and rationalizing ways of closing the debate in favour of one side, but nuancing and offering the same space, time and resources on explaining what's at stake at both ends of the spectrum. This would foster agonistic pluralism by offering different perspectives and addressing the systematic roots of the topic, not the superficial emotions or personal feelings it triggers. What these terms mean, whether this is the case in the selected media landscape and how it looks for the specific topic of this paper will be analysed, discussed and answered in the continuation of this paper.

## Literature review & theoretical framework

To understand the motivation behind this research, it is helpful to situate it in a broader conversation in society. The connection between media discourse and democratic debate and the way these activate the public's participation is a core component of a functioning democracy (King et al., 2017). This is partly why it is so important to keep analyzing how this interplay evolves and how it is being practiced in different nations, contexts, topics and outlets.

### *The Populist Moment and Its Societal Implications*

By situating this discourse withing a broader societal context, we can link it again to what Mouffe (2019) calls the *populist moment*, revealing how media reports on certain topics in time of societal crises. A certain way of reporting has led to the creation of a fertile breeding ground for populist leaders like Trump to rise to power. Mouffe argues that we find ourselves in a period of political conflict between left and right-wing populism, suggesting we should reclaim and expand the democratic debate to counter these rising regressive, nationalist tendencies – like mentioned earlier in relation to Trump – to address this crisis. She further suggests a stride towards left populism to offer an alternative way to answer people's problems. This can be realized through social movements (e.g. *environmental campaigns, workers' rights groups*) and working towards a united 'collective will', instead of divisive, elitist strategies characterised by right wing populism. This is relevant for the topic of this paper as well, since many fault lines and issues surrounding the election are translatable to this 'right vs. left-wing struggle', resulting in an over-arching 'post-politics vs. agonistic politics' (Mouffe, 2019).

### *Agonistic Media Pluralism: Embracing Conflict in Democratic Debate*

Another theoretical foundation of this paper is Chantal Mouffe's view on *agonistic media pluralism*. This entails the idea of fostering a healthy democracy by questioning which voices are being excluded or marginalized and how we should combat dominant, hegemonic ruling norms which are partly enforced by certain routine media processes (Budarick, 2020). Mouffe proposes that these conflicts shouldn't be repressed in favour of a consensus or status quo, but they should be contested and fostered in a healthy, democratic manner where all voices, hegemonic or not, can participate (Budarick, 2018).

Mouffe also emphasizes the role of alternative and ethnic media. They have the power to voice these marginalized, counter-hegemonic ideas and groups, giving them a platform to contribute to the democratic debate. This is why her theory is implemented in this study and will be used to examine which voices and objects are prominent in the media discourse surrounding Trump's victory, but also which ones are not part of the general discussion. By analyzing how our media frames certain topics in terms of language use, linguistic and discursive strategies, it can unveil how this topic is being (de)politicised in the selected Flemish media outlets and what its debate looks like.

These factors will be conceptualized in terms of ‘scope’ and ‘form’. *Scope* refers to the actors, objects and ideological preferences in a media text. *Form* describes the lay-out, linguistic and discursive strategies being used. By analyzing the media discourse in this way, we can ultimately decide if the debate surrounding this particular issue is mostly being *opened* or *closed*. Opening a debate is done via politicization; by offering *exposure* to certain voices and – equally important – being mindful of the voices that aren’t being supported, makes it possible to widen the democratic debate, incorporating the larger scope of a certain issue. By *expanding* the debate in this way, media can create a space for alternative voices, actors and ideas, indirectly exposing limitations in the current, hegemonic representations of said issue. Closing a debate is done via depoliticization: by presenting certain ideas surrounding a topic or debate as the only *moral* or *rational* way, texts can exclude other ideas and present them as delegitimate, immoral or irrational (*or not present them at all*). Mouffe’s framework offers a lens to analyse how the debate is being opened or closed and understand these techniques used by media to foster or impede on an agonistic debate (Mouffe, 2011; Maesele & Raeijmaekers 2017).

### *Mainstream Media and the Status Quo*

Another study by Maesele & Raeijmaekers (2017) states how mainstream or legacy media often echo establishment ideas and can fail to challenge the status quo, resulting in what is earlier described as *depoliticizing* or *closing* the debate. Their work proposes CDA as a way to examine the media’s role in a deeper and more layered manner, examining the ideological assumptions that are shown - *or hidden* - ‘in between the words’ of media texts. By analyzing how different media outlets construct the same social reality by highlighting different ideological contestations and excluding others, we can eventually evaluate their democratic quality and ideological culture. Their work partly serves as a guideline for the structure and methodology of this paper.

### *Critical Discourse Moments: A Framework for Analysis*

Another central anchor in the sphere of this paper is the work of Anabela Carvalho. She introduces *Critical Discourse Moments (CDM)* as a starting point for CDA research. Her definition of these pivotal moments in society is in line with the selection of this paper’s subject. The debates surrounding Trump has been known to upheave a lot of discourse and studying the aftermath of his victory fits into the vision of Carvalho’s CDM description. Previously mentioned criteria of *scope* and *form* also lay in line with her work. She adds a distinction between *extra-textual* and *supra-textual effects*. Extra-textual effects refer to what’s happening outside media texts, alluding to the way media discourse has the power to change policies, start movements and spark action. Supra-textual effects refer to how a combination of media texts can collectively shape or constrain debates in society (Carvalho, 2008). An example of a hypothesised extra-textual effect of Trump’s victory discourse in Belgium would be that local far-right parties mirror Trump’s victory as one of their own, framing it as a ‘resurgence of right-wing populism’ and contributing it to their own success. A broader and maybe even more dire hypothesis is that his rhetoric about organizational mistrust (*e.g. leaving the Paris Climate Agreement*) might inspire other populist nations to follow similar behaviours.

It is also relevant to contribute to the local research on the framing of international events like the U.S. election. By understanding our own media environment and the dynamics that are present in each of these outlets, we gain a deeper understanding of certain motives, stances and are able to recognise patterns in the reporting of these different media outlets. Comparing this to other media landscapes teaches us more about our own, and how it might be improved.

### *Broader Social Issue of U.S. Election Reporting*

Research shows that the results of 2016's U.S. election increased uncertainty and instability in Europe, questioning the U.S.'s global leadership (Pedaliu, 2016). Reporting on this topic can also have significant effects on ongoing conflicts in the Middle East. It further raises questions about the U.S.'s position within international politics, with the nation steering further and further away from liberal internationalism (Baldaro & Dian, 2018) and moving more towards right-wing populist and nationalist ideas, seen in other countries as well (Worth, 2022). This can have a cascading effect on international politics, with more populist leaders setting an example to follow this shift.

Earlier studies also show how Flanders, although scoring fairly high on media concentration, still manages to foster a pluralistic environment. Belgian media policies are able to grant freedom to the media, particularly in written press (Van Besien, 2010), encouraging plural voices within the landscape. Another study states that Belgium has a strong focus on foreign news reporting compared to other regions. Major U.S. events, such as presidential elections and 9/11, and other international conflicts that involve U.S. interests tend to dominate Belgian newspapers (Depres, 2005). While both these studies are relatively old in terms of how fast media changes, this paper will examine whether these claims (still) stand in today's media landscape regarding this U.S. topic of Trump's 2024 electoral victory.



# Methodology

## Research design

As previously stated, the structure of a Critical Discourse Analysis allows for detailed and thorough analysis of a certain social issue or Critical Discourse Moment (CDM) through the lens of the selected media outlets. By reviewing media discourse in terms of scope and form, discovering underlaying discursive strategies, we can unveil certain mechanisms of different media discourses and gain an understanding of how a specific media discourse fosters pluralism and agonistic debate, or fails to contribute to a democratic and inclusive public sphere.

The relevance lies in being able to reveal how power, ideology and social structures influence media discourse and as a result, public opinion. By examining forms of inclusion/exclusion, ways of framing a certain topic and other discursive strategies, we're able to expose the (de)politization at work within certain media texts. The hope is to contribute to a more agonistic media debate. The next section will state which cases were selected for this CDA and why they were chosen in that particular way.

## Case selection

As stated before, three media outlets were chosen for further analysis. The corpus of this study includes articles from *De Morgen*, *Doorbraak* and *Apache*. The timeframe was spanned over exactly one month, from the 4<sup>th</sup> of November 2024 until the 4<sup>th</sup> of December 2024. This ensured enough coverage of the U.S. elections (5<sup>th</sup> of November 2024), including a day prior to the election results, as well as the weeks after Trump's victory announcement. Data was collected via *Belgapress*, Belgium's national news agency database that offers a streamlined strategy to select articles from different Belgian media outlets (Belgapress, 2024). *Doorbraak*, however, isn't included in *Belgapress*' catalogue. A monthly subscription fee was paid to access *Doorbraak*'s full article archive and select articles from the presented timeframe.

Keywords were carefully curated to ensure systematic and equal representativeness of each outlet. For this research, 'Donald', 'Trump' and 'Elections' were the main keywords, with having 'Trump' in the title or intro as selection criterium. This was done so news that only mentioned Trump as a side-topic, or just referred to him unrelated to the 2024 U.S. elections wasn't selected. For *De Morgen*, only articles in the printed version of the newspaper were selected (*as opposed to their weekend magazine or other side publications*). This ensured that all articles stayed within the relevant scope of this study, namely the Trump's victory of the 2024 U.S. presidential elections. A clear and even selection process also prevented the cherry-picking of articles, resulting in a fair, comparable article corpus. The final database contains 26 articles total, eight from *Apache* (labelled 'API – AP8'), eight from *Doorbraak* (labelled 'DB1 – DB8') and the final ten from *De Morgen* (labelled 'DMI – DM10'). All references to these articles are found in *Appendix A – Article database*.

It can be valuable to position the selected outlets in Flanders' wider media landscape before starting the analysis. This, however, might skew the reader in a certain way so therefore these descriptions are strictly objective, widely known renditions of how the three outlets position themselves in our media landscape, so that readers unfamiliar with the media landscape still have a frame of reference.

***De Morgen*** is the only mainstream medium in this study. It is positioned as a progressive, quality newspaper. It has old history in Flanders' socialist press but is now owned by DPG Media, a prominent media conglomerate in Belgium and the Netherlands. De Morgen offers attention to diverse societal topics, aligning with the traits of a quality newspaper (De Morgen, 2024).

***Doorbraak*** positions itself as a Flemish-nationalist opinion medium, focusing on societal and political aspects of the Flemish movement, offering an alternative platform for opinions outside of the mainstream media. Its history is rooted within the Flemish Movement but isn't outspokenly attached to any political party anymore (Doorbraak, 2024).

***Apache*** is an independent alternative medium for investigative journalism. It is critical towards elitist powers and has a progressive focus based on a cooperative structure. It puts emphasis on its independency from commercial pressure and focus on facts (Apache, 2024).

These outlets were chosen because of their unique positioning, offering *hypothesized* different views on the topic and contributing to the democratic debate in different ways. All articles were read in Dutch. Any used quotes and other relevant elements were translated from Dutch to English, verbatim. The result of this case selection is visualised in *Appendix A – Article database*. This is the full list of all selected articles in the given timeframe, supplied with all relevant identifiers to ensure transparency and replicability.

## Empirical case study - analysis

This analysis will discuss the process and findings of the CDA by presenting how the three outlets discursively reconstruct narratives about Trump's victory of the 2024 U.S. elections. It unveils which strategies are being used *within and across* the selected media outlets and broader Flemish media landscape. Rather than just isolating and analyzing the outlets separately, it also reveals how these narratives shape the democratic debate in the Flemish media landscape as a whole. This also enables a comparison between the legacy media outlet and alternative outlets, discussing in which way they contribute to the debate surrounding the chosen topic.

### Discursive constructions

This paragraph examines three reoccurring discursive constructions in each of the media outlets. Every construction is divided in the ways the media outlets contributed to its creation.

#### I. Polarization and Victimization: Constructing the Marginalized 'Us'

This first construction is created by certain media's tendency to divide groups into binaries and oppose them to each other, resulting in an '*us vs. them*'-rhetoric. Victimization of certain groups creates a polarised environment and a discourse that reinforces, emphasizes and promotes further division instead of moving towards a more mutual understanding of the larger topic. This often results in a closed debate around who is, *morally or rationally*, superior and alienates the ones that are not. However, by including different voices, perspectives and focusing on shared goals, media can open the debate within this construction, victimizing certain parties but still keeping the surrounding debate open for wider discussion. In other words, polarisation and victimization can exist without instantly closing a debate. The next subparagraphs will discuss how this discursive construction is found in each of the outlets.

##### Doorbraak

Doorbraak frequently constructs a collective 'us' by portraying Trump's supporters as victims of certain liberal-progressive ideas. In article DB8, Doorbraak frames the male Trump supporters as the new target of those ideas: "*Underneath the progressive discourse of 'connectedness' lies a lot of pent-up hatred. The (male) Trump fan is the new target*". They frame an 'us' as a result of a certain cultural war. They blame 'wokers' and Sanctorum's piece emphasizes how these progressive discourses 'alienate' men and promotes hatred towards them, even comparing those groups to 'sectarianism' and painting feminism as an oppressive, polarizing force. It delegitimizes these social movements and closes the debate around them, offering no room for mutual understanding. DB7 critiques Democrats in a similar way. They blame Harris' campaign for focusing too heavily on demographics to win over certain groups (*e.g. the African-American, Latino groups*). That article mentions Latino and Black voters that shifted to Trump as evidence for this disillusion within the Democrat party. Again, this binary distinction promotes the victimization of the Trump voter and politicizes the media debate.

Doorbraak's narrative puts forward a battle with Trump voters on one side and 'the progressives' on the other. Ironic language and hyperboles are often used in their articles to reinforce this sense of victimhood. By using emotionally loaded language, they heavily moralise the debate. It politicizes these self-titled 'cultural war', while at the same time delegitimizing critique against populist right-wing politics, narrowing the debate in their own self-interest.

"Progressives talk a lot about solidarity, but they cultivate hatred and exclusion like no other [...] their discourse is imbued with delusions of superiority, revenge and hatred towards those who think differently. [...] The right is by their definition the worst that bubbles up in man and may therefore be spat upon, eliminated and cancelled".

### Apache

Apache's framing of this victimization shifts to more systemic issues. Article AP1 critiques the American media landscape for being too profit-driven and complicit in maintaining right-wing, populist ideas. By describing Trump's 2024 victory as "*In the circus, the clown wins*", also the title of that piece, it victimizes the American democracy as a whole. AP8 elaborates on this in a European context and warns about a possible 'Trump 2.0', which will (in)directly also affect Western democracy. Here, the 'us' is investigative, democratic journalism while the other side is commercialism and populism.

While that strategy somewhat closes the debate through victimization, Apache also looks at the other side: "*The Democrats preferred to sacrifice their electoral base on the left to attract phantom voters on the right*" (AP2). By adding this, the scope of the debate is being widened and Democrats are seen as victims of their own electoral strategies as well. By not only criticizing Trump's strategies, but also look at the shortcomings of the left, the debate is being opened. This way of depoliticization looks both sides. Voices within Apache like Naomi Klein state that that Harris' campaign "*didn't care about minorities at all*" and how she put too much focus on winning over undecided voters. In AP6, the journalist also states the importance of looking beyond binary distinctions between 'good' and 'bad', condemning this form moralization: "*But not everyone is hyper-partisan, and we ourselves are of course somewhat more open-minded than that. So we consider the characteristics of the candidates in more detail*" (AP6).

By broadening the debate, Apache includes system critique in both directions. Expert voices and data-driven analysis add to this, but the still moralising tone towards populist tendencies tends to close that part of the debate again and form the 'us' of their story. The following quote from AP5 demonstrates this populist critique, where the journalist writes about how the election was more about expressive and outrageous figures like Elon Musk, than about actual democracy: "*All-powerful businessmen and distracting entertainers receive far more attention in our over-mediated, ultra-capitalist society than questioning thinkers and doubting artists*" (AP5). This altogether also exposes the ideological underpinning of Apache as an investigative journalism magazine.

### *De Morgen*

Legacy newspaper *De Morgen* offers a nuanced, but still somewhat victimizing narrative. It focusses on the *potential* dangers of his leadership, with language like this already referring to a more balanced, impartial look at the debate. Some titles, however, tend to frame the debate in a certain way via specific language use: “*Fear of nuclear attack - With Trump the situation becomes more explosive*” (DM8).

DM8 and DM9 highlight these global fears of nuclear escalation and weakened alliances within Europe. They put forward the European democracies as biggest victims of Trump’s ‘erratic’ behaviour. By victimizing international allies like Ukraine and NAVO-connections possibly weakening (DM 3), it differs from earlier perspectives where the ‘us’-narrative was mostly within the nation itself. *De Morgen* widens this, by framing it as an international issue, with players like the EU and democratic institutions seen as vulnerable to this populist disruption and adding figures like Orbán and Meloni to the mix of populist leaders.

*De Morgen*’s reporting includes a broad selection of actors and events, framing the debate through interviews, analysis and often led by American politic experts and sources like *The New York Times* lead to a broader, more opened debate. *De Morgen* also features an article that voices the Republicans who won, showing their happiness, faith and trust in Trump widens the scope further and includes both critique and praise for Trump’s U.S. election. That being said, the remaining focus on Trump’s unpredictability remains sharp and tends to close that debate, often portraying him this way does set up a narrative in which certain ideological stances unveil themselves:

It is certain that his [Trump] return to the White House threatens to further inflame a number of global conflicts. The fact that the man described by everyone as ‘unpredictable’ will soon have access to some 5,000 nuclear warheads again – only Russia has more – makes the concern even greater. (DM8)

## **2. Constructing ‘The People’ and ‘The Elite’: Framing populist mobilization**

Media discourse in this construction focusses on framing elites as corrupt, promoting the idea that the regular ‘people’ are being ignored or even oppressed by institutions, movements or other oppressive forces. The outlets differ in defining who those oppressors or ‘people’ are, offering different and opposing views of who the ‘corrupt or disconnected’ players are as well. This often results in little room left for deeper discussions and underlying causes of the struggles that built these so-called divisions. Only by critically and objectively examining each side of this construction can the debate be opened and shifted from blame towards more systematic critique, giving deeper and underlaying mechanisms the chance to appear and be debated in a more open manner.

## Doorbraak

This outlet uses a populist rhetoric to portray Trump as ‘champion of *the people*’. DB2 questions why Trump’s victory is deemed incomprehensible by so many intellectual elites. The article voices Rik Torfs stating that every political leader should have some ‘mean traits’ and be a bit ‘cunning’ to serve their people. He critiques the ‘moral blindness’ of journalists and academics who dismiss Trump’s appeal. Torfs frames these critics as being ‘disconnected from ordinary American reality’. DB6 highlights that more Latinos voted for Trump, framing the ‘woke language of the Democrats and influx of illegal immigrants’ as a possible contributor to Trump’s victory. This article is written by a self-titled misanthrope and adds that Harris lost a lot of Black, male voters to Trump, reinforcing the framing of Trump as a spokesperson for the silent majority, his ‘people’ that do understand him.

DB4 praises Trump’s ‘anti-political mainstream’ and contrasts it against the hypocrisy of traditional politicians and Democrats. The writer, Scantorum, describes Trump with colourful language like “*a brilliant performer*”, thus aligning with ‘the people’, Trump’s voters. DB1 emphasizes how Biden’s pardon of his son, Hunter, was a betrayal of ‘his people’, by an elitist, self-serving government. By framing Biden’s pardon as selfish, it further feeds polarisation.

The narrow scope created by this tunnel vision on cultural differences and tactics is amplified with language heavy in irony and exaggeration. The focus on Trump being humorous and framing his outrageous behaviour as ‘intelligent comedy’ is further illustrated by this quote: “[...] *top notch meta-humour, where the future president radiates power and parody*” (DB4). This paints the picture of a president who has a good-humoured connection with ‘his people’. The article claims that the people who want to portray Trump as populist or even fascist are just ‘wandering’. These stark dichotomies offer little nuance and tend to narrow the debate. Little to no alternative voices or actors are offered, making this media debate closed and one-sided.

## Apache

Apache critiques the populist mobilization of politics, examining how populist leaders construct their concept of ‘the people’, while also recognising and admitting its effectiveness. AP3 warns of Trump’s ‘messianic’ image amongst his followers possibly risking and undermining democratic institutions. His rhetoric is being framed as a “*literal and figurative attack on democracy*”. Apache frames Trump’s ‘people’ as driven by emotion and irrational beliefs.

AP5 offers a parallel between Trump and other European populists (*e.g. Meloni, Orbán*) to illustrate the global threat of this mobilization. The journalist further explores how Trump has no real history in science, art or philosophy and describes how such plutocrats suppress centre-left politicians from rising to power, staying behind without great capital. Similar to other articles from the outlet, it describes Trump as harmful for democracy: “*cash-addicted and mass-addicted President Trump is so deeply disruptive to American democracy and social*

debate” (AP5). AP7 continues this stance, stating that Trump “*won by a racist and fascist program*”.

AP2 critiques both left and right, attributing Trump’s rise and victory to systematic failures in both sides of the political spectrum. Naomi Klein, the interviewee of this article, argues that Harris neglected her core voters in favour of gaining more right-wingers, as discussed in the first ideological construction: “*The Democratic Party has turned its back on its potential voters. That was clear*”. This highlights how the ordinary Americans, mostly young and minority voters, felt ignored by the Democratic ‘elite’, and is thus how they let their people down.

By allowing a voice like Klein’s, a social activist, critique both sides, it widens the debate and its scope. The transnational comparisons also offer a wide scope, framing Trump’s victory on a larger scale. While being broad, the discourse still often immortalizes populism, rationalising the alternative by framing it as a moral crisis and reducing room for an alternative perspective on these populist critiques.

### *De Morgen*

De Morgen analyses the inner workings of Trump’s populist appeal with a critical, yet analytical lens. DM2 and DM3 show how Trump’s ‘macho persona’ resonates with a certain demographic. DM7 highlights how Trump appoints positions in his government to people that are loyal to him, rather than prioritizing qualification or expertise. This presents him even more as ‘a man of *his people*’, constructing a hand-picked elite that aligns especially well with his own beliefs. The article also praises Trump in a way, more specifically on how his protectionist strategy of promising a better economy seems to have worked. DM5 adds to this debate, saying “*a team full of stars can either work or completely fail*”, referring to Trump’s elite being saturated with celebrities or entertainers like Elon Musk, a Fox News presenter, ‘television doctors’ and more: “*Now Trump is well prepared and immediately comes up with extreme appointments based on loyalty. Competence and experience play no role. That is exceptional and never seen before in the U.S.*” (DM6). A political scientist from Gent University explains that such an elite can work, since ‘stars’ are generally good communicators, but that they need expertise too.

The form of this outlet mixes expertise with analysis and own interpretations of the journalists. It creates a semi-open debate, still relying on rationalising a big portion of the debate by being wary of the dangers in Trump’s populist strategies. By not relying on heavy emotional or sensational language, it still offers a more nuanced and balanced look on this construction.

### 3. Framing the Moral Battlefield: Delegitimizing Opponents in Media Discourse

The final construction shows how political and ideological conflict is often framed through morals and the delegitimization of the opponents. By emphasizing moral shortcomings such as hypocrisy, corruption or extremism, it tries to delegitimize opposing viewpoints. It often reduces debates to binary morals like in the first construction, which tends to close the way to constructive dialogue. This, however, can be combatted by recognizing strengths and optimism in opposing views rather than writing them off completely.

#### *Doorbraak*

DB1 speaks to Biden's pardon and how it was a betrayal of public trust, framing him as a self-serving politician. This contrasts with how they depict Trump: a leader aligned with 'The People'. They also claim that *"everyone knew Biden was lying"* when he said he wouldn't pardon his son in the past. DB3 talks about how Trump's disruptive tactics can 'wake the people up', supported by the following quote: *"Donald Trump forces us to look beyond everyday life. For or against the man, that is his first and greatest achievement"*. In DB4, Sanctorum tries to frame Democrats as somewhat hypocritical, while describing Trump as someone who is able to *"undress political rhetoric to its core"*, further illustrated by the following quote: *"a foul-mouthed super-performer who totally dismantles political theatre and frees it from the morally hypocritical aura that Democrats excelled in"*. This construction of the image of an authentic disruptor of the status quo, while simultaneously delegitimizing the opposition delegitimizes his opponents. DB7 emphasizes how Kamala convinces fewer Black voters than initially estimated and how Trump won these people over, again critiquing Harris' strategy. The article also calls Harris' 'joy' unauthentic, delegitimizing her optimistic and generally cheerful personality. The journalist goes on by stating that the celebrities who endorsed the Democrat candidate (e.g. *Taylor Swift, Beyonce*) weren't even able to turn the tide, 'Wow!' the author adds. DB5 also criticises Harris for spending almost double the money on her campaign compared to Trump.

Again, this narrower scope with a lot of self-serving journalist and topics leads to a closed debate, delegitimizing the tactics of the Democrats while praising Trump for his victory and personality. With emotive and sometimes even provocative language, it simplifies complex dynamics into simple, weaponised arguments that feed the idea of this construction's 'moral battlefield'.

#### *Apache*

Again, Apache's approach to delegitimizing opposing views often targets systemic enablers of this right-wing populism. It is a more nuanced approach, featuring less divisive or emotive language and with a stronger focus on systematic issues and international tendencies, rather than personal, vindictive strategies. One of its journalists, David Neiwert (*American politics expert and climate journalist*), highlights how Trump's policies worsen social inequalities, calls him an 'as clear as day fascist' and talks about how Trump can get away with anything, from misogyny to fraud: *"If it turns out that Trump eats children for breakfast, he will still get away with it"* (AP1). It also offers broader media critique, stating that news has to sell and that



America's democracy 'bleeds' as a result of its focus on "*clickbait and disproportionately exaggerated news*", and how this puts the public debate into the hands of profit motives and big companies. Neiwert compares the 2024 election with a 'verbal boxing match', focused on the delegitimization of the opponent, "*where the loudest player gained the most attention, leading to clicks, views and thus commercial profit*" (AP1). This sensationalism is presented as a central force behind Trump's rise. AP8 warns that this erosion of media integrity in the U.S. is linked to similar risks in Europe, with media commercialization as moral failure that prioritizes money over truth. AP4 titled "*How democracy destroys itself*" references both the extreme right *and* left as guilty for the situation America finds itself in. It involves topics like Trump's nationalist view on defence, with Belgium not being ready to invest more in military forces. They further delegitimize the right by stating that they "*[...] often uses diversionary tactics to avoid having to go along with a leftist agenda of universal economic rights*", again referring to the populist traits of the Republican campaign.

Within this discursive construction, Apache uses expertise and investigative journalism to boost its arguments. With detailed analysis and moral evaluation, it invites the reader to reflect on systemic flaws but fails to leave room for different perspectives on Trump's strategies. While they still don't give in to overly emotive language, they do portray Trump as a somewhat illegit leader, with words like 'clear as day fascist', their language is still coloured. This adds to the 'moral battlefield'. Their way of delegitimization is more focused on experts and international analysis rather than purely on emotion or sentiment, which creates more room for professional discussion. The inclusion of American politic experts, academics and other voices aids in offering knowledge-backed arguments to fuel their debate, enlarging the scope.

### *De Morgen*

This outlet sets focus on the global implications of Trump's leadership. He is framed as an international destabilizing force. DM8 discusses the risk of nuclear escalation under Trump, morally delegitimizing his irresponsibility and unpredictability. DM10 mentions Trump's legal battles as a frame of his 'defiance of the law', further stating this by hypothesizing that he will most likely pardon all the offenders present at the January 6<sup>th</sup> storming of the U.S. Capitol in 2021, again indirectly mentioning his (mis)use of power. De Morgen further expresses concern for Trump's alliances with other authoritarian leaders like Putin. These relationships are framed as morally reprehensible and again, alarming for global stability (DM9). By putting this moralisation upon Trump's actions, De Morgen delegitimizes at least parts of his leadership, while positioning democratic institutions as the morally superior option, opposing these two on the 'moral battlefield' within this construction.

By discussing geopolitical events through the lens of a broad spectrum of actors with diverse backgrounds, De Morgen manages to depoliticise the global impact of Trump's actions and victory, while moralizing the consequences. While it opens the debate in that first way, also mentioning the existing diversity of Trump's government (DM4). The underlaying messaging does more often than not, fall back on warning the reader of the consequences, which then in its second part narrows the debate more to a close.

## Summary

*Doorbraak* tends to heavily polarize this topic, closing the debate by reinforcing these binary, black and white narratives which excludes alternative actors, viewpoints and discourse. This way, it shows its underlying ideologic stance that's centred around Flemish nationalism. These ideological cultures will be further discussed in the conclusion of this paper.

*Apache* balances its systemic critique by analyzing populist tactics from different viewpoints. While their ideological positioning within the media landscape also often shines through, it manages to offer a more elaborate view with less emotive language compared to *Doorbraak*, opening the debate more. Their broader scope does help in widening the debate, not being afraid of acknowledging shortcomings in both camps, it tends to leave space for ideological contestation. Still, *Apache* often moralizes the debate in a certain way, narrowing the possibility of the alternative to be seen as valid or legitimate.

Finally, *De Morgen* largely opens the debate by including diverse perspectives, analysts and narratives, with a broader focus on global implications of Trump's tactics. Their expert-based analysis offer a more substantiated base for their arguments, which occasionally still rationally frames certain populist and nationalist ideas as inferior, slightly limiting the fully opened debate that would be possible otherwise. Still, they manage to balance their ideological orientation by offering quality articles, also showing how this differs from the other two, alternative media outlets. This difference will also be discussed in the conclusion of this paper.

## Conclusion

### Media pluralism and agonistic debate

The way these outlets contribute to the same discursive constructions, yet often in strikingly opposite ways, highlights the media pluralism they bring to the broader landscape. Like Mouffe (1999) argues, these different ways of allowing contestation, conflicting insights and different strategies to exist within the media landscape promotes diversity and contributes to a healthy democratic society. That, however, raises the question about how these outlets operate in a vacuum, separate from each other.

There are significant differences in how these each contribute to the bigger surrounding debate, as shown in the analysis. They each offer a different contribution to the agonistic pluralism we know in Belgium today. This, however, isn't always a given. This paper's topic allows for the unique opportunity to also evaluate the state of America's media pluralism. In Trump's world, the media pieces that criticise him, *like CNN*, are often written off as 'fake news' and illegitimate (Guo, 2021). This can pose a great threat, since Mouffe advocates for allowing conflict to exist rather than only let the media serve one side of the whole story, a possible reality that Trump often clearly alludes to. That's what agonistic pluralism is all about: giving space to contesting ideas and conflict, allowing opposing views to talk to each other instead of living in separate bubbles.

### Relation to the populist moment

The conclusions of this paper are closely connected to Chantal Mouffe's idea of the *populist moment*. The constructions found within this study relate to the rise of populist movements, driven by public dissatisfaction, as will be seen in both ends of the presented fault lines (page 21). Flemish reporting on Trump's victory explores these key societal divisions, which can even be found in our own politics. These directly reflect Mouffe's argument that democratic debate needs to embrace these conflicting perspectives through earlier mentioned agonistic pluralism. This research shows how media can either contribute to this pluralism by offering an open debate, supported by different actors, opinions, styles and analysis, or further fuel this disconnect by closing the debate around certain ideas considered legitimate by the writer or outlet.

## **Ideological cultures**

Another part of this analysis are the ideological cultures of each outlet. This concept is explained by Carvalho (2007) and refers to the shared ideas, values and preferences of a media outlet/organization and by extension, their audiences. It shapes how an outlet interprets, reports and frames certain topics according to their unique value systems, influenced by a combination of different aspects. Now that we've analysed them thoroughly, we can describe their ideological culture and see how it aligns with their own, self-proclaimed ideological stance.

*Doorbraak's* nationalist and rather conservative ideological culture aligns well with its self-described mission of fostering the Flemish identity (Doorbraak, 2024). While often framing in binary terms, focusing on cultural and political grievances, the goal of mobilizing Flemish causes becomes clear. This, however, like discussed in the analysis, limits the potential to contribute to a pluralistic debate, framing opposite ideologies as threats or dangers, reinforcing the populist-nationalist rhetoric, which is part of the reason why this outlet has its strong opinion, often more in favour of Trump's values.

*Apache* also seems to practice what they preach, offering progressive, independent journalism with systemic critique, contributing to a more reflective debate that exposes structural flaws in both populist and elite strategies, not afraid to look at both sides of the political spectrum. Apache fosters a critical and investigative media environment that underscores the need for democratic accountability and aligns with their vision on journalism (Apache, 2024). However, occasionally it relies on moral judgement and in doing so, risks alienating certain perspectives while outspokenly favouring a certain direction.

*De Morgen's* liberal-internationalist culture in this paper is consistent with its mission of promoting progressive values and democratic discourse (De Morgen, 2024). The outlet incorporates diverse voices and situating Trump's leadership within a global context opens the debate around geopolitical risk. Its frequent moralization of populism and authoritarianism narrows the discussion in those areas, but despite that, De Morgen remains a significant contributor to pluralistic debate.

## **Fault lines**

The introduction of this study proposed a handful of fault lines at play within the debate around Trump and the 2024 U.S. elections. With the available analysis data, we're able to reconstruct these fault lines backed by supportive evidence from within the articles. This section will stay concise, since many of these fault lines already (in)directly presented themselves in the analysis and discursive constructions. The three most prominent fault lines will be discussed, but naturally there are many others that could be reconstructed based on the earlier analysis.

### *Progressivism vs. Conservatism*

This first fault line reflects the ideological divide surrounding the values, identities and social hierarchies of the current (global) political system. Flemish media often reinforces this polarization by framing progressive movements as a disruptive force, threatening traditions and 'national values', while conservatism is seen as the morally righteous choice to preserve cultural identity. The other side of this fault line disagrees and sees progressivism as a path to societal improvement, inclusion and equality, often regarding conservatist structures as outdated and asking for a change. Some outlets are able to critique both sides, as seen in the analysis, while others stick to a more binary division, rationalising one of both sides. Whatever tactic is used, this fault line is still heavily present in our Flemish media discourse.

### *Nationalism vs. Globalism*

A second fault line is constructed based on the tensions between a nationalist focus within a globalised world. Nationalism is defended as a protective measure against globalist 'control', framed as a short-sighted ideology undermining global stability. Trump's 'America First' rhetoric leans heavily towards a more nationalist focus, having worldwide effects on international alliances like those with NATO and the Paris Climate Agreement. This is a reaction to a belief that global governance could impede on national sovereignty. The other side of this fault line promotes and encourages international cooperation for accomplishing shared goals (*e.g. climate accords and public health*), framing nationalist ideas as harmful for global stability. Flemish media that align with this perspective see globalism as a necessity, while others agree with the importance of nationalist culture preservation.

### *Populism vs. Democracy*

This last fault line, also the most prominent one, needs little introduction. It reflects the tension between populist movements, seen by some as a response to the failure of elite governments and democratic institutions and essential corrective for social stability. Framed in our media by a necessary correction to institutional dysfunction, minimizing the extremist definition of populism, while the other side sees it as a divisive, anti-institutional threat to our democracy. As Mouffe states (2019) in her concept of '*the populist moment*', this fault line underscores the need for a democratic reform that addresses this systematic discontent on both sides and does so while maintaining institutional integrity.

## **Alternative vs. legacy media**

This analysis finally lets us compare the umbrella-terms ‘legacy’ and ‘alternative’ media. Being careful with generalizations, since this paper only examined one legacy and two alternative media outlets, it’s still clear that the earlier discussed ideological cultures differ from one to the other.

*De Morgen*, legacy and mainstream outlet, has a more general focus on prioritizing broad coverage and follows more traditional journalistic roles. Their reporting is generally more balanced and neutral, while still showing its progressive roots, colouring their reporting slightly. It addresses a wide audience and in doing so, has to adhere to this more broad, balanced approach that legacy Flemish media typically follow.

*Doorbraak* and *Apache*, the alternative outlets, are ‘allowed’ to form a more specific, focused opinion and stance on certain topics. They both claim to bring news coverage that isn’t shown in traditional media, and both dare to colour outside of the ‘mainstream lines’, often characterised by more emotive language use, stronger opinions and more outspoken actors that challenge existing power dynamics.

Both contribute to the pluralistic media landscape in their own way, offering diverse, opposing views that add to a larger, democratic landscape, as previously discussed at the start of this conclusion. The fact that all these outlets can exist next to each other can lead to the conclusion that *together*, they add to fostering a democratic debate.

## **Limitations and future research**

An important sidenote to this study has to be made regarding its sample size. The study only managed to review 26 articles total, focusing on just one main Critical Discourse Moment: Trump’s 2024 election. To be able to make any substantial statements about the ideological orientation, discursive strategies or other findings discussed in this paper, similar studies about similar topics and outlets would have to be replicated, preferably with a larger sample size. This study also isn’t peer-reviewed and was written for a class assignment, adding to the caution with which results should be studied and generalised. For transparency’s sake, all sources are included and can be checked via the information in Appendix A – Article database

It is also important to note that this paper describes an international, foreign event through the lens of Flemish, national media. Research supports the fact that news is reported differently on, based on whether it’s national or international (Deprez, 2005). It is likely that these three media outlets would report differently, with different scope, form and strategies, to the election of a new member in our own political system, compared to an international leader. Basing the ideological cultures of an outlet purely on the reporting of international event might lead to certain biases that wouldn’t exist if this paper had chosen a national topic to cover. Future research could focus on including more or other outlets, increasing the sample size and examining other topics to see whether these discursive constructions also show in the reporting on different social issues.

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## Appendix A – Article database

| Article ID | Media outlet | Title                                                                                                                                    | Article type | Author/journalist    | Date       | Link                                                                                                                                                                                  |
|------------|--------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------|----------------------|------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| DB1        | Doorbraak    | 'Een volledig en onvoorwaardelijk pardon'                                                                                                | News         | Roan Asselman        | 3/12/2024  | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/een-volledig-en-onvoorwaardelijk-pardon">https://doorbraak.be/een-volledig-en-onvoorwaardelijk-pardon</a>                                               |
| DB2        | Doorbraak    | De onbegrijpelijke verkiezing van Donald Trump                                                                                           | Column       | Rik Torfs            | 9/11/2024  | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/de-onbegrijpelijke-verkiezing-van-donald-trump">https://doorbraak.be/de-onbegrijpelijke-verkiezing-van-donald-trump</a>                                 |
| DB3        | Doorbraak    | Trump, een zegen voor ons geweten                                                                                                        | Forum        | Alexander De Mont    | 10/11/2024 | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/trump-een-zegen-voor-ons-geweten">https://doorbraak.be/trump-een-zegen-voor-ons-geweten</a>                                                             |
| DB4        | Doorbraak    | Donald Trump, de man die grappiger is dan zijn eigen karikatuur                                                                          | Column       | Johan Sanctorum      | 11/11/2024 | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/donald-trump-de-man-die-grappiger-is-dan-zijn-eigen-karikatuur">https://doorbraak.be/donald-trump-de-man-die-grappiger-is-dan-zijn-eigen-karikatuur</a> |
| DB5        | Doorbraak    | De overwinning van Donald Trump in 10 getallen                                                                                           | Column       | Roan Asselman        | 11/11/2024 | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/de-overwinning-van-donald-trump-in-10-getallen">https://doorbraak.be/de-overwinning-van-donald-trump-in-10-getallen</a>                                 |
| DB6        | Doorbraak    | Landslide voor Donald Trump                                                                                                              | News         | Winfried Matheeußen  | 6/11/2024  | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/trump-wint-2">https://doorbraak.be/trump-wint-2</a>                                                                                                     |
| DB7        | Doorbraak    | Donald Trump, de comeback kid                                                                                                            | News         | Roan Asselman        | 6/11/2024  | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/donald-trump-comeback-kid-2">https://doorbraak.be/donald-trump-comeback-kid-2</a>                                                                       |
| DB8        | Doorbraak    | Feministen plannen homicide op Trumpstemmers                                                                                             | Column       | Johan Sanctorum      | 18/11/2024 | <a href="https://doorbraak.be/feministen-plannen-homicide-op-trump-stemmers">https://doorbraak.be/feministen-plannen-homicide-op-trump-stemmers</a>                                   |
| AP1        | Apache       | In het circus wint de clown                                                                                                              | Analysis     | Tom Cochez           | 6/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/3cead5e0-2833-4b01-b697-c233e907f055">https://share.belga.press/news/3cead5e0-2833-4b01-b697-c233e907f055</a>                                 |
| AP2        | Apache       | Naomi Klein: 'Zelfs in een dystopische film is dit Amerikaanse scenario ongeloofwaardig'                                                 | Interview    | Joseph Confavreux    | 4/12/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/bc5e8155-6cdc-43f0-8f2b-482c2e6e4203">https://share.belga.press/news/bc5e8155-6cdc-43f0-8f2b-482c2e6e4203</a>                                 |
| AP3        | Apache       | 'Trump neemt het niet op tegen de Democraten, maar tegen de democratie'                                                                  | Interview    | Frederik Polfliet    | 4/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/66b4dee1-eab4-4ea3-afe1-3eb7e77407c0">https://share.belga.press/news/66b4dee1-eab4-4ea3-afe1-3eb7e77407c0</a>                                 |
| AP4        | Apache       | Hoe een democratie zichzelf vernietigt                                                                                                   | Analysis     | Karl van den Broeck  | 9/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/c9634748-79fb-40de-a92a-a656eb60bb79">https://share.belga.press/news/c9634748-79fb-40de-a92a-a656eb60bb79</a>                                 |
| AP5        | Apache       | Van Berlusconi tot Trump                                                                                                                 | Debate       | Wouter Hessels       | 21/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/ee5c7f1e-f10b-4e8f-8865-6d8fa1eed5f2">https://share.belga.press/news/ee5c7f1e-f10b-4e8f-8865-6d8fa1eed5f2</a>                                 |
| AP6        | Apache       | De goeden en de slechten                                                                                                                 | Debate       | Koen Smets           | 22/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/11ebdf0c-f08c-4e8a-94d3-9e2b1cb51b57">https://share.belga.press/news/11ebdf0c-f08c-4e8a-94d3-9e2b1cb51b57</a>                                 |
| AP7        | Apache       | Wat te zingen in deze tijd?                                                                                                              | Analysis     | Karl van den Broeck  | 16/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/de675501-c6b0-4162-afa6-bcf370eba933">https://share.belga.press/news/de675501-c6b0-4162-afa6-bcf370eba933</a>                                 |
| AP8        | Apache       | De schuld van de media                                                                                                                   | Analysis     | Tom Cochez           | 22/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/9e991945-5e8a-4619-87fb-102449ce8258">https://share.belga.press/news/9e991945-5e8a-4619-87fb-102449ce8258</a>                                 |
| DM1        | De Morgen    | Republikeinen aan het feest na ruime zege van Donald Trump - 'Dit waren vier moeilijke jaren, maar ik voel eindelijk hoop'               | News         | Thomas Rueb          | 7/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/64c0f2ea-7e93-4916-ac65-1c9d3ebf4fe7">https://share.belga.press/news/64c0f2ea-7e93-4916-ac65-1c9d3ebf4fe7</a>                                 |
| DM2        | De Morgen    | Amerika-kenner Bart Kerremans analyseert de 'stevige' MAGA-overwinning - 'Zijn trouwe aanhangers zien in Trump een soort messias'        | Interview    | Stavros Kelepouris   | 7/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/a3e93a58-fb2f-4adf-9443-ff8dc4fc7228">https://share.belga.press/news/a3e93a58-fb2f-4adf-9443-ff8dc4fc7228</a>                                 |
| DM3        | De Morgen    | Zes lessen - Eet trumpiaanse revolutie straks haar eigen kinderen op?                                                                    | Analyse      | Maarten Rabaey       | 7/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/4bf43f20-ba26-437e-a5a8-233e98158487">https://share.belga.press/news/4bf43f20-ba26-437e-a5a8-233e98158487</a>                                 |
| DM4        | De Morgen    | In Trumps toekomstige regering vind je verscheidenheid aan overtuigingen - Zelfs de MAGA-vlag dekt verschillende ladingen                | News         | David E. Sanger      | 27/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/39e37b80-55ae-4bc1-9af9-964ef04e8694">https://share.belga.press/news/39e37b80-55ae-4bc1-9af9-964ef04e8694</a>                                 |
| DM5        | De Morgen    | Aanstellingen Trump - Een team vol sterren kan werken, of helemaal mislukken                                                             | News         | Steven Elias         | 21/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/4ea06b03-8c46-4b4d-b080-8046f055e67c">https://share.belga.press/news/4ea06b03-8c46-4b4d-b080-8046f055e67c</a>                                 |
| DM6        | De Morgen    | Amerika-kenner Kristiaan Versluys analyseert de toekomstige VS-regering - 'Met Trumps benoemingen zijn we in een ander paradigma beland' | Interview    | Kristiaan Versluys   | 15/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/2863a015-3c76-4705-8df5-3e1c998faf64">https://share.belga.press/news/2863a015-3c76-4705-8df5-3e1c998faf64</a>                                 |
| DM7        | De Morgen    | Verkiezingen VS - Wie trouw bleef aan Trump mag nu rekenen op een topjob                                                                 | Analysis     | Thomas Van de Wal    | 13/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/3a2c3cec-6a0b-4c0c-a761-f3f939418f53">https://share.belga.press/news/3a2c3cec-6a0b-4c0c-a761-f3f939418f53</a>                                 |
| DM8        | De Morgen    | Vrees voor kernaanval - Met Trump wordt de toestand explosiever                                                                          | News         | Lotte Beckers        | 12/11/2024 | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/db5bf54b-9964-41ee-a57e-0762cd9aae6c">https://share.belga.press/news/db5bf54b-9964-41ee-a57e-0762cd9aae6c</a>                                 |
| DM9        | De Morgen    | Oorlog met Rusland - Bromance Trump-Poetin kan lot Oekraïne bepalen                                                                      | News         | Yannick Verberckmoes | 9/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/a24d7315-33ec-4a7c-9a5d-5d99a552fc98">https://share.belga.press/news/a24d7315-33ec-4a7c-9a5d-5d99a552fc98</a>                                 |
| DM10       | De Morgen    | Rechtszaken Trump - Al streep door twee federale zaken tegen nieuwe president                                                            | News         | Brent Lanting        | 8/11/2024  | <a href="https://share.belga.press/news/74857049-fec8-4061-96db-ad90f7eb9ae5">https://share.belga.press/news/74857049-fec8-4061-96db-ad90f7eb9ae5</a>                                 |

Figure 1. Overview of the selected articles of each outlet and their corresponding data.